

PROCESS SUMMARY REPORT

Application of the Tornberg Method to the

PRELIMINARY U.S. ELECTION SECURITY RISK ASSESSMENT

Risks, Vulnerabilities, and Threat Vectors Affecting the U.S. Electoral Process

PROCESS SUMMARY REPORT 2026-02A | 18 JULY 2026

CONTROLLING DISCLAIMER

This document and the products or outputs it summarizes were generated through collaborative Principal Consultant use of the Tornberg Analyst GPT and the resulting human review, coordination and assessment of compliance with doctrine, standards, and analytic frameworks.

DRAFT FOR REVIEW, COORDINATION, AND REVISION

Companion product summarized: Preliminary National-Level Assessment - Risks, Vulnerabilities, and Threat Vectors Affecting the U.S. Electoral Process, Preliminary Intelligence Assessment 2026-02, 29 pages.

0. Document Status and Guide

STATUS

This report documents work actually performed during the collaborative development of the companion assessment. It does not certify the accuracy of every source, resolve the remaining legal or technical questions, or constitute an approval or release determination.

Field	Controlled statement
Purpose	Make the path from the original question to the current draft visible, auditable, and reviewable.
Audience	The accountable analyst, coordinating reviewers, technical and legal specialists, source auditors, and publication authorities.
Review status	The user reported completion of a first-pass review with minor edits. No independent analytical peer review, full source audit, legal review, technical review, red-team review, tradecraft compliance determination, approval, or release authorization has been represented as complete.
Source boundary	Public, declassified, official, judicial, technical, administrative, academic, advocacy, commercial, and investigative materials were used. No classified or privileged access was represented.
Method boundary	Only methods and controls actually used are described as executed. Proposed future work and outstanding review requirements are separated from the executed pathway.
Relationship to companion product	The 29-page assessment carries the substantive judgments. This report explains the development, evidence controls, methods, adaptations, and remaining gaps behind that draft.

Document guide

Section	Purpose
Executive Summary	Principal process judgments and current review status.
1-3	Engagement purpose, baseline, decision support, and Discovery.
4-5	Collection, source integrity, falsification, provenance, and independence.
6-9	Analytical design, threat-vector development, quantification, and control architecture.
10-12	Challenge, production, review, human accountability, and lessons learned.
Appendices	Executed pathway, framework traceability, source dispositions, methods, and review checklist.

Executive. Summary

BOTTOM LINE

The engagement began as an extension of a PRC-specific election-interference baseline and developed into a system-wide preliminary assessment of U.S. election-security threat vectors, vulnerabilities, controls, and information gaps. The work produced a 15-vector Threat Vector-Gap Register, a 10-code gap architecture, proposition-specific confidence, bounded quantitative anchors, and a five-layer preventive and forensic assurance model. The companion assessment is decision-useful as a draft, but it is not release-ready.

#	Process judgment	Basis
1	Discovery materially changed the product.	The work shifted from an actor-specific inquiry to a national system model after the terrain analysis showed that registration, eligibility, cyber, physical, insider, financial, reporting, information, and systemic-failure vectors required one integrated architecture.
2	Evidence-stage separation controlled the inquiry.	Vulnerability, attempt, access or transaction, acceptance, count effect, certification effect, and outcome effect were treated as distinct propositions. This prevented duplicate registrations, allegations, technical access, or reporting errors from being presented as proof of counted-ballot or outcome effects.
3	A warning threshold was established without manufacturing prevalence.	One validated exploitation event was treated as sufficient to establish operational exploitability and warning value. It was not treated as evidence of national frequency, likely recurrence, coordination, or outcome determination.
4	Quantification was redesigned around demonstrable metrics.	The team rejected a composite risk score and instead used exposure, observed exploitation, control coverage, control performance, detectability, consequence stage, warning indicators, gap burden, and confidence.
5	Prevention and independent verification were integrated.	The initial emphasis on forensic reconstruction was refined into a five-layer model: prevent; detect; contain/correct; independently verify; recover/learn. Eligibility assurance was paired with due process, alternative evidence, cure, appeal, provisional participation, and measurement of both improper activation and improper exclusion.
6	Source integrity materially affected substantive judgments.	Official sources were used for national administrative context and legal or technical orientation. Advocacy, commercial, and case-repository sources were bounded, deconflicted, or quarantined. Direct falsification checks removed or narrowed several high-impact claims.
7	The current product remains preliminary.	The user completed a first-pass review with minor edits. Independent source, legal, technical, tradecraft, red-team, editorial, approval, and release reviews remain outstanding.

Baseline effect

Effect	Process result
Reinforces	Multiple election-security vectors are real and warning-relevant because documented exploitation, official findings, direct observation, and technical reporting establish operational pathways.
Refines	Existence, exploitation, recurrence, scale, effect, and confidence are separate judgments. A vector may be warning-relevant while national prevalence remains unresolved.
Contradicts	Purposive case repositories, anomaly counts, duplicate registrations, allegations, referrals, charges, and convictions cannot be combined into one national fraud rate.
Replaces	The initial forensic-heavy assurance framing was replaced by an integrated preventive, detective, corrective, independent-verification, and recovery model.

1. Relationship to the Companion Product

What this report explains and what remains in the substantive assessment.

The companion assessment presents the substantive national-level judgments, 15 threat vectors, quantitative and actionable anchors, preventive and forensic controls, recommendations, alternatives, information gaps, controlled definitions, and a selected source register. It is a 29-page public-source draft marked for review, coordination, and revision. [C-01]

This process summary explains how the inquiry was framed, how the evidence base was expanded and controlled, which methods were used, how the baseline changed during collaboration, why certain claims were bounded or quarantined, how the final product architecture emerged, and which reviews remain incomplete.

CONTROLLING STANDARD

A process summary should show how the question was framed, how evidence was controlled, how uncertainty was handled, which alternatives were considered, how judgments were communicated, and what would cause those judgments to change. Professional appearance alone is not evidence of rigor.

Engagement boundaries

- The work used public, declassified, officially released, judicial, technical, administrative, academic, advocacy, commercial, and high-quality investigative materials.
- No classified access, privileged government access, protected investigative files, or undisclosed proprietary reporting was represented.
- The inquiry assessed risks, vulnerabilities, threat vectors, controls, and warning value. It did not establish nationwide compromise of certified vote counts.
- Legal characterizations were treated as analytical orientation. The product does not constitute legal advice or a legal opinion.
- Case and advocacy datasets were used to establish documented pathways and within-dataset frequencies only; they were not treated as representative national incidence datasets.
- The final draft preserved unresolved gaps rather than resolving them through speculation.

2. Engagement Baseline and Decision Supported

How the problem was restated for a senior analyst advising the National Authority.

2.1 Initial position

Starting baseline. The prior work concerned the PRC-specific aspect of U.S. election interference. That work supported strong judgments concerning PRC collection and processing of voter, campaign, political, communications, and personal information, while preserving incomplete bridge evidence concerning specific outcome-directed operations and finding no established PRC alteration of ballots, tabulation, certification, or the 2020 result. [TB-PRC-01]

Client direction. The user requested expansion beyond the PRC into multiple vectors affecting election security as a whole, specified collaborative mode, and directed that the work begin with Discovery.

2.2 Decision support requirement

Element	Controlled frame
Supported decision	Help a senior analyst advising the National Authority identify consequential election-security exposures, practical vulnerabilities, warning conditions, information gaps, and U.S.-controlled risk-reduction options.
Required product	A preliminary national-level intelligence assessment suitable for senior review, with unresolved gaps displayed rather than hidden.
Primary horizon	The 2026 federal election cycle through final certification; structural reforms considered through 2028 where implementation requires more than one cycle.
Decision criteria	Evidence quality, operational exploitability, exposure, control coverage, detectability, consequence stage, legal feasibility, fairness, auditability, resilience, and U.S. control.
Consequence of error	Overstatement could undermine credibility, lawful access, or public trust. Understatement could leave demonstrated pathways unmitigated until exploitation becomes more consequential.

2.3 Principal analytical question

PRINCIPAL ANALYTICAL QUESTION

What risks, vulnerabilities, and threat vectors affect the U.S. electoral process as a whole and voting integrity in particular; what evidence establishes each vector; how can each be quantified through meaningful, demonstrable, and where possible actionable measures; what material gaps constrain judgment; and which lawful, practical controls within the U.S. sphere of control merit executive consideration?

3. Discovery

How the inquiry moved from the initial baseline to a system-wide assessment.

Discovery stage	What occurred	Output
Establish Position	Prior PRC baseline, existing public-source products, client understanding, trained-user preference, collaborative mode, known source packet, and stated concern about speculative judgments.	Operational baseline and initial evidence-stage controls.
Define the Destination	Senior-level preliminary assessment; meaningful quantification; practical controls within U.S. law; process detail largely reserved for a companion summary.	Decision statement, audience, time horizon, and product requirements.
Explore the Terrain	Registration, eligibility, identity, mail voting, custody, insiders, cyber, vendors, reporting, finance, influence, systemic failure, legal variation, and decentralized administration.	Candidate vector map, lifecycle model, controllable vulnerabilities, and gap register.
Select the Instruments	Decision discovery, baseline development, environmental discovery, risk discovery, collection design, evidence mapping, source audit, falsification, assumption review, vulnerability analysis, indicators and warning, alternatives, and consequence reasoning.	Proportionate method set; no composite risk score or unsupported quantitative model.
Learn and Adapt	The user repeatedly challenged framing and controls, including the warning threshold, O’Keefe source treatment, dataset frequency language, prevention versus forensics, and fairness safeguards.	Revised baseline, five-layer assurance model, dual-error standard, and final product structure.

3.1 Discovery instruments actually used

Instrument	Executed use
DI-200 Decision Discovery	Defined the National Authority support requirement, audience, time horizon, consequence of error, and expected preliminary product.
DI-300 Baseline Development	Established the PRC-specific starting baseline and repeatedly updated the system-wide operational baseline as evidence and user direction changed.
DI-400 Environmental Discovery	Mapped the decentralized legal, administrative, technical, physical, information, and foreign-threat environment.
DI-600 Risk Discovery	Identified threat vectors, vulnerabilities, failure pathways, control weaknesses, potential consequences, and warning conditions.
DI-700 Collection Design	Converted unknowns into G-01 through G-10, source priorities, falsification tests, metrics, and vector-specific collection requirements.
DI-800 Discovery Integration	Integrated the baseline, vector register, gap register, controls, recommendations, alternatives, and review requirements into the companion assessment.

3.2 Major discovery pivots

Pivot	Effect on analysis
Actor-specific to system-wide	The unit of analysis shifted from PRC conduct to the whole U.S. election lifecycle and its interacting domestic and foreign vectors.
Fraud examples to threat pathways	The inquiry moved from counting examples to determining which vulnerabilities had been operationally exploited and what later stages remained unproven.
National frequency to dataset-bounded frequency	“Most common” was restricted to the identified dataset, period, inclusion rules, unit, and coding scheme.
Forensic assurance to layered assurance	Independent reconstruction remained essential but was placed after preventive input assurance, detection, and containment.
Eligibility enforcement to dual-error integrity	Improper activation and improper exclusion were treated as coequal integrity failures requiring measurable safeguards.

4. Collection and Source Development

How evidence was expanded in response to gaps rather than accumulated indiscriminately.

4.1 Source classes collected

Source class	Representative materials	Permitted use
Primary official administrative data	EAC 2024 EAVS; EAC voter-list, audit, voting-system, and technology guidance; Census voting and registration data.	National exposure, terminology, administrative controls, official practice, and denominators.
Judicial and prosecutorial records	DOJ election-crime orientation and case records, including the Armstrong paid-registration matter.	Verified conduct, legal status, evidence stage, and bounded exploitation examples.
Official technical and threat guidance	NIST election infrastructure profile; CISA/FBI/ODNI foreign influence guidance; National Academies.	Cyber, vendor, audit, resilience, information-operation, and independent-evidence logic.
Academic and methodological sources	MIT Election Data + Science Lab interstate matching synthesis.	False positives, false negatives, fields, thresholds, and identity-resolution limits.
Investigative observation	O’Keefe testimony and publicly released video series.	Directly observed paid-registration, false-address, petition, identity, and voter-data exploitation pathways.
Advocacy and commercial analyses	Fight Voter Fraud, Tilores/Medium, Public Interest Legal Foundation, Heritage, Gitnux, Zipdo, Bradley map.	Lead generation, method examples, case discovery, falsification targets, and within-dataset pattern analysis.
Prior controlled products	PRC baseline assessment, time-gated evidence deconfliction, public source packet, prior process summary.	Prior baseline, source controls, baseline-warning architecture, and deconfliction standards.

4.2 Collection logic

- Official and primary sources were preferred for national administrative measures, legal orientation, technical controls, and case disposition.
- Advocacy, commercial, and investigative sources were retained when they exposed a relevant pathway, method, or lead; their claims were not strengthened by rhetorical certainty.
- Claims were decomposed into directly falsifiable propositions before additional collection.
- New evidence was sought to close specific bridges: identity, registration, ballot availability, return, acceptance, count, intent, disposition, effect, and detectability.
- The source set was broadened across vectors after the initial evidence base proved heavily weighted toward registration and conventional fraud.
- No complete national incident census was found or represented.

4.3 Collection products created during collaboration

Artifact	Function
Discovery Source Audit Addenda	Source-by-source status, permitted use, confidence, limitations, and baseline effects.
Direct Falsification Record	Targeted checks against official audits, legislative reports, DOJ records, and underlying dataset structure.
Threat Vector-Gap Register	Fifteen threat vectors linked to evidence stage, metrics, controls, gaps, and confidence.
Gap Code Register	Ten cross-cutting gaps controlling completeness, detectability, bridges, controls, law, exposure, actor, coverage, warning, and source integrity.
Preventive and Forensic Control Architecture	Five assurance layers plus eligibility-specific fairness safeguards and dual-error measures.
Selected Source Register	Principal sources, source class, primary use, and principal limitation in the companion assessment.

5. Source Integrity, Independence, and Falsification

Controls applied before evidence was allowed to strengthen a judgment.

5.1 Governing controls actually applied

Control	Applied treatment
Evidence precedes assessment	Material judgments were tied to identified evidence or explicitly labeled inference, assumption, or warning.
Proposition-specific support	A source supporting one stage was not used as proof of later stages.
Source characterization	Official, judicial, technical, academic, investigative, advocacy, commercial, and prior-synthesis sources were not treated as equivalent.
Provenance and retrievability	Direct source records were preferred; shortened links, opaque claim sourcing, and missing methods reduced weight.
Independence and deconfliction	Repeated claims from a common source stream were treated as one stream. Medium and Tilores were deconflicted; overlapping case repositories were not counted as independent corroboration.
Corroboration	Corroboration required an independent evidence stream supporting the same bounded proposition.
Quarantine	Numerical claims with unresolved definitions, methods, source mapping, or bridge evidence were preserved as leads but excluded from definitive prose.
Contrary evidence	Official audits and reports contradicting high-impact claims were actively sought and retained.
Confidence discipline	Confidence followed evidence quality, independence, corroboration, and gaps; it did not follow source volume or rhetorical certainty.

5.2 Representative source dispositions

Source	Disposition	Reason
EAC 2024 EAVS	SUPPORTED / HIGH for bounded national administrative measures.	Strongest national administrative dataset; still limited by item definitions, completeness, and jurisdictional reporting variation.
MIT interstate matching	CONTEXT / HIGH for methodology.	Supports matching limitations and ordinary explanations; does not validate any commercial or advocacy total.
Fight Voter Fraud	QUARANTINED for exact national totals.	Opaque matching rules, no reproducible dataset, no measured error rates, and unresolved category reconciliation.
Tilores / Medium	SUPPORTED / BOUNDED for candidate matches; QUARANTINED for exact fraud claims.	One derivative source stream with commercial interest and incomplete validation methods.
Public Interest Legal Foundation	SUPPORTED / BOUNDED for candidate anomalies.	More visible method than other advocacy sources, but no executable rules, validation sample, independent audit, or bridge to criminal conduct.
Heritage database export	SUPPORTED / BOUNDED as case-discovery repository.	1,619-row purposive dataset with mixed dispositions, repeated rows, overlapping categories, and uneven source depth; not a national rate.
Bradley map	SUPPORTED / BOUNDED as transparent discovery index.	Useful inclusion rules and case links; completeness and prevalence calculations not established.
Gitnux / Zipdo	QUARANTINED for substantive quantitative use.	Claim-source mapping, definitions, and reproducibility failed; multiple high-impact claims were contradicted or unsupported.
O'Keefe / Armstrong	DIRECTLY OBSERVED plus official corroboration for bounded conduct.	Video, testimony, referral, federal charging, and plea-account evidence support paid registration and false-address exposure; not every filmed actor or downstream ballot stage has a final disposition.

5.3 Direct falsification checks performed

Claim tested	Falsification result	Analytic disposition
North Carolina “515 confirmed double votes”	Official post-election audit reported 24 substantiated cases, with additional review and false-positive cautions.	Claim excluded as stated.
Antrim County “6,000 software vote flips”	Official review found human reporting/configuration error and accurate machine tabulation confirmed by hand tally.	Software-flip claim excluded; event retained as reporting/configuration and information-risk example.
Heritage “1,500+ investigated and convicted”	Export contained mixed dispositions rather than one conviction category.	Replaced with exact dataset-bounded categories and limitations.
Michigan “174,000 returned before requested”	No supporting primary record located; number appeared conflated with another official statistic.	Quarantined pending claim-specific primary support.
Bradley “1 in 2.1 million”	Arithmetic reproducible, but selected detected cases divided by all ballots is not an incidence estimator when detection and capture are unknown.	Retained only as a descriptive ratio of catalogued cases, not prevalence.

6. Analytical Design and Methods Actually Used

The least-complex methods capable of improving the judgment were selected.

METHOD RULE

A technique organized or challenged evidence; it did not create evidence. Outputs remained analytical work and were not converted into facts merely because they were structured.

Method	Execution	Vulnerability addressed
Problem and question decomposition	Separated the broad topic into lifecycle stages, actor classes, threat vectors, controls, metrics, and decision questions.	Prevented an unbounded “election interference” topic from producing generic conclusions.
Evidence mapping and claim-stage matrix	Mapped facts, reported information, inference, assessment, warning, and consequence stage.	Prevented duplicate registration, system access, or allegation from being treated as proof of ballot or outcome effect.
Source characterization and deconflation	Classified provenance, maturity, independence, derivative relationships, and permitted use.	Controlled source inflation and repeated claims.
Data-quality assessment	Audited the Heritage export structure, dispositions, duplicates, coding variation, and source fields.	Prevented row count from being treated as unique incidents, convictions, or a national rate.
Contradiction mapping / falsification	Tested high-impact secondary claims against primary official records.	Removed false, conflated, or unsupported claims before synthesis.
Iterative assumption review	Tested duplicate-registration logic, warning threshold, source sufficiency, technology reliance, eligibility validation, and fairness.	Exposed hidden premises and produced bounded, conditional judgments. No standalone scored assumption worksheet was completed.
Vulnerability and exposure analysis	Identified entry points, required access, susceptible populations or systems, control dependencies, and residual unknowns.	Made each vector operational rather than rhetorical.
Indicators and warning	Separated baseline finding from warning judgment and defined observable indicators for each vector.	Allowed warning before widespread or outcome-determinative exploitation was established.
Alternative analysis / analyst-led devil’s advocacy	Retained moderating explanations concerning decentralization, technology benefits, administrative anomalies, and foreign influence effects.	Prevented one-sided recommendations and preserved conditions that would weaken the principal judgment.
Consequence and recommendation traceability	Linked each recommendation to vectors, controls, measures, tradeoffs, and time horizon.	Prevented recommendation from preceding evidence or becoming detached from the assessed vulnerability.

6.1 Methods deliberately not used

Method not executed	Reason
Composite risk score	Rejected because unlike vectors lacked common, defensible inputs and a score would create false precision.
National fraud-rate estimate	Not attempted because no representative incident universe, consistent denominator, or known detection probability was available.
Bayesian or Monte Carlo model	Not used because input probabilities and conditional relationships were not sufficiently evidenced.
Formal Analysis of Competing Hypotheses matrix	Credible alternatives were retained and tested, but no complete ACH worksheet or independent scoring panel was executed.
Independent Red Team / Team A-Team B	Not executed. The draft identifies this as a required independent review before release.
Legal opinion or compliance determination	Not executed. Legal issues were framed for counsel and jurisdiction-specific review.

7. Threat Vector-Gap Register Development

How the central analytic structure was built.

The register became the heart of the assessment. Each vector was required to show a bounded evidence-backed baseline, warning judgment, demonstrable or actionable metric, primary preventive control, forensic or assurance control, indicators, principal gaps, and proposition-specific confidence. [C-01, pp. 8-14]

Family	Vector IDs	Coverage
Registration and eligibility	TV-01 through TV-04	List integrity, eligibility exploitation, identity misuse, duplicate voting.
Ballot access and participation	TV-05 through TV-07	Mail-ballot exploitation, buying/coercion/paid registration, petition and ballot-access fraud.
Trusted access and technology	TV-08 through TV-10	Insiders, cyber compromise, vendors/equipment/software/supply chain.
Physical and authority processes	TV-11 through TV-12	Custody, stuffing, destruction, reporting, canvass, recount, certification.
Influence and finance	TV-13 through TV-14	Information operations, public-confidence attacks, illicit finance, covert political support.
Systemic resilience	TV-15	Accidental, cascading, infrastructure, workforce, and common-vendor failure.

7.1 Gap architecture

Code	Gap	Controlling question
G-01	Completeness and coverage	Relevant incident, jurisdiction, period, actor, and disposition universe.
G-02	Detection and observability	Whether attempted or successful activity would produce, preserve, and receive review of evidence.
G-03	Evidence-stage bridge	How far conduct progressed from vulnerability through effect.
G-04	Control performance and residual risk	Coverage, prevention, detection, false positives, false negatives, correction, and bypass.
G-05	Legal and procedural normalization	Jurisdictional definitions, eligibility rules, offense elements, and remedies.
G-06	Exposure and denominator	Population, transaction, system, user, ballot type, or jurisdiction actually exposed.
G-07	Actor attribution, intent, and coordination	Identity, access, authority, resources, objective, and coordination.
G-08	System and vector coverage	Evidence concentration in some vectors and undercollection in others.
G-09	Warning design	Indicators, thresholds, ownership, cadence, and response.
G-10	Source integrity and independence	Provenance, definitions, retrievability, dependence, corroboration, and corrections.

7.2 Separation of existence from scale and effect

Judgment	Required basis
Vector exists	At least one credible mechanism, vulnerability, or documented pathway is established.
Vector exploited	At least one supported attempt, transaction, access event, or completed offense crossed from possibility into conduct.
Recurrence likely	Requires evidence about frequency, incentives, access, controls, and relevant time horizon.
Scalable	Requires evidence that actors can repeat, automate, coordinate, or expand the pathway under real constraints.

Judgment	Required basis
Material effect	Requires bridge evidence to accepted ballots, counts, certification, participation, administration, or strategic confidence effects.

8. Quantification and Actionable Metrics

How the customer's quantification requirement was met without false precision.

8.1 Quantification dimensions

Dimension	Decision use
Exposure	Size of susceptible population, transaction set, system, jurisdiction, workforce, or privilege group.
Observed exploitation	Verified cases, convictions, official findings, directly observed transactions, intrusions, or control activations.
Control coverage	Proportion of exposure protected by a defined preventive, detective, or assurance control.
Control performance	False acceptance, false rejection, detection, cure, reconciliation, correction, recovery, or audit escalation.
Detectability	Likelihood that activity would create, preserve, and receive review of observable evidence.
Consequence stage	Farthest supported stage from vulnerability through outcome effect.
Warning indicator	Observable condition triggering attention, collection, preparation, or action.
Gap burden	G-01 through G-10 gaps limiting a stronger judgment.
Confidence	Evidence quality for the proposition, independent of likelihood or consequence.

8.2 Frequency-language control

CONTROLLED WORDING

"Most common" means most frequent within the identified dataset, period, unit, inclusion rules, and coding scheme unless a representative national basis is independently established. Dataset frequency is not national prevalence.

8.3 Metric-design principles

- Use the denominator relevant to the vector rather than total national ballots by default.
- Measure both control failure and control activation; rejection, cure, correction, and reconciliation may show safeguards working.
- Track false acceptance and false rejection when eligibility or identity systems can harm either integrity or lawful access.
- Distinguish exposure measures from exploitation measures and both from effect measures.
- Prefer measurable coverage and performance indicators over unsupported probability labels.
- State when a number comes from a purposive dataset, official administrative survey, case repository, or analytical count.

9. Preventive and Forensic Assurance Architecture

How the product balanced stopping invalid inputs with reconstructing outcomes.

9.1 Five-layer control model

Layer	Control objective
1. Prevent	Stop invalid, unauthorized, or malicious inputs before activation.
2. Detect	Identify attempts, errors, and control bypass.

Layer	Control objective
3. Contain / Correct	Limit spread, resolve records, preserve evidence, and prevent downstream effect.
4. Independently Verify	Reconstruct process and outcome using evidence outside the originating system.
5. Recover / Learn	Restore operations, remediate weakness, and update the baseline.

9.2 Eligibility assurance and fairness

Safeguard	Applied principle
Control objective	Affirmatively support every legally material criterion before ordinary activation whenever legally and operationally possible.
No single-database veto	A mismatch, missing record, or stale record triggers resolution rather than automatic rejection.
Alternative evidence	Provide equivalent lawful means to establish identity, citizenship where applicable, age, residence, restoration, and other criteria.
Secondary review	Require documented human review before consequential denial based on automated matching or conflicting data.
Notice and cure	State the unresolved criterion, evidence, alternatives, deadline, assistance, consequences, and review path.
Provisional participation	Preserve lawful participation where eligibility cannot be resolved before the deadline and law provides a provisional path.
Appeal and correction	Provide review quickly enough to matter for the election and retain original and corrected records.
Special cases	Address naturalization, name changes, restored rights, homelessness, protected addresses, military and overseas voters, disability, language, nonstandard addresses, and system outage without lowering the substantive standard.
Dual-error metric	Measure both improper activation and improper exclusion.

9.3 Major adaptation

BASELINE REPLACEMENT

The earlier framing prioritized independent reconstruction as the principal national risk-reduction opportunity. Collaboration exposed a critical upstream omission. The baseline was replaced with a layered assurance judgment: strong pre-entry validation, fair exception handling, detection, containment, independent verification, and recovery are complementary controls; none substitutes for the others.

10. Assumption Testing, Alternatives, and Challenge

How the inquiry was protected from preferred conclusions.

10.1 Material assumptions tested during collaboration

Assumption	Result	Effect
Duplicate registration is evidence of duplicate voting.	Rejected.	Duplicate registration may create a pathway, but ballot issuance, return, acceptance, count, and intent require separate evidence.
Widespread exploitation is required before a warning is justified.	Rejected.	One validated exploitation establishes operational exploitability and may support warning, while scale and recurrence remain unresolved.
Government or prosecutorial action automatically creates independent corroboration.	Refined.	Action strengthens status and may add evidence, but independence depends on whether the action relies on the same originating evidence stream.
Paper records alone establish outcome assurance.	Rejected.	Custody, ballot accounting, audit design, escalation, and independence determine assurance value.

Assumption	Result	Effect
Technology is inherently the principal risk.	Refined.	Technology often improves reliability and access; risk rises when platforms create common-mode dependence or supply the only evidence of correctness.
Strict eligibility validation can rely on database mismatch.	Rejected.	Accurate input assurance requires alternative evidence, due process, secondary review, cure, appeal, and measurement of improper exclusion.
Decentralization is only a vulnerability.	Refined.	Decentralization creates uneven assurance but can also reduce single-point national failure; common standards should focus on outcomes and evidence rather than one operating model.

10.2 Credible alternatives retained

Alternative	Treatment
Decentralization materially reduces national-scale risk.	Retained as a moderating condition. It does not eliminate common-vendor, data, information, or assurance risks.
Most administrative anomalies are ordinary complexity rather than fraud.	Retained with caveats. It constrains anomaly-based inference but does not eliminate documented exploitation pathways.
Existing controls are broadly effective.	Retained as possible and partly supported by cure, rejection, correction, and audit activity. National residual risk remains difficult to measure.
Technology improves reliability more than it increases risk.	Retained and refined. The recommendation is independent evidence and controlled access, not indiscriminate removal of technology.
Foreign influence is primarily rhetorical, not election security.	Not adopted. Influence can affect participation, officials, certification, resource allocation, and confidence without altering ballots.

10.3 Challenge not completed

Independent challenge remains outstanding. The collaboration included user challenge, analyst-led alternative analysis, and iterative devil's-advocacy checks. It did not include an independent Red Team, separate Team A/Team B assessment, blind source audit, or qualified technical/legal panel. Those functions must not be inferred from the existence of alternatives in the draft.

11. Production and Traceability

How the analytical record was converted into a senior-level preliminary product.

11.1 Product architecture applied

Component	Visible output
Executive Lead	Principal judgment, bottom line, confidence, and six priority judgments.
Analytical Scope and Quantification	Evidence-stage rule, baseline-warning distinction, quantification dimensions, frequency-language control, and gap codes.
National Exposure and Assurance Baseline	EAVS scale measures, what those measures establish, controllable vulnerabilities, and integrated control model.
Threat Vector-Gap Register	Summary register plus 15 detailed vector records.
Integrated Assessment	System-wide judgments on real vectors, warning value, registration data, technology, foreign exploitation, detectability, and baseline effects.
Preventive and Forensic Assurance Architecture	Eligibility, fairness, independent evidence, technology assurance, and manual continuity.
Decision Considerations and Recommendations	Tradeoffs, recommendations linked to vectors and metrics, near-term priorities, and measures of success.
Information Gaps and Indicators	Cross-vector gaps, vector-specific indicators, and collection/control requirements.

Component	Visible output
Assumptions, Alternatives, and Limitations	Material assumptions, moderating alternatives, review limits, and human accountability.
Appendices	Definitions and confidence, selected source register, and review/release requirements.

11.2 Production requirements visibly applied

- The product identifies the supported decision, audience, scope, horizon, preliminary status, and limitations.
- The principal judgment precedes supporting detail.
- Evidence-backed baselines, warning judgments, implications, decision considerations, recommendations, assumptions, alternatives, and gaps are separated.
- Major confidence statements are proposition-specific and include rationale.
- Quantitative claims display source boundaries and do not imply unsupported national prevalence.
- Recommendations are linked to vectors, purposes, metrics, and horizons.
- The draft preserves review requirements and states that unqualified release is not authorized.
- The product includes version identity, handling markings, page numbers, selected source register, and review appendix.

11.3 Production history

Stage	Produced result
Discovery working records	Provisional baseline, terrain map, source controls, gap priorities, and collaborative questions.
Source audit addenda	Duplicate-registration, voter-fraud, database, O'Keefe, and category-claim evaluations.
Threat Vector-Gap Register 0.1	Fifteen vectors, ten gap codes, confidence separation, and collection integration.
Analytical Design 0.1	National Authority audience, preliminary product identity, quantification method, integrated assessment, and mitigation levers.
Preventive-control revisions	Pre-entry eligibility assurance, fairness safeguards, alternative evidence, due process, dual-error standard, and five-layer control model.
Full companion draft	29-page Preliminary Intelligence Assessment 2026-02.
Human review	User reported a first-pass review with minor edits; the reviewed PDF is the version summarized here.

12. Review Status, Human Accountability, and Lessons Learned

What has occurred, what has not, and what the engagement changed.

12.1 Review status

Review	Status	Limitation
User first-pass review	Completed as reported by the user; minor edits incorporated into the reviewed PDF.	Not represented as formal source, legal, technical, tradecraft, or release approval.
AI consistency and production support	Completed iteratively during drafting and artifact creation.	AI output is assistance, not compliance determination or approval.
Independent analytical peer review	Not completed.	Required before any final high-consequence client-facing release.
Full source audit	Not completed.	Material claims, quotations, URLs, statistics, dispositions, source independence, and source packet alignment remain to be verified.
Legal review	Not completed.	NVRA, HAVA, UOCAVA, Voting Rights Act, privacy, federalism, and state-law implications require qualified counsel.
Technical review	Not completed.	Cybersecurity, voting systems, e-pollbooks, audits, logging, vendors, custody, and continuity require qualified specialists.

Review	Status	Limitation
Tradecraft compliance review	Not completed.	Evidence-stage separation, confidence, alternatives, metric validity, recommendation traceability, and AI assistance require formal evaluation.
Red-team review	Not completed.	Framing, vector selection, principal systemic judgment, exclusion risk, and centralized common-mode risk require independent challenge.
Editorial/visual proof	Partial drafting QA occurred; no final independent publication proof is represented.	Accessibility, references, pagination, table breaks, and cross-version consistency remain release requirements.
Approval and release authorization	Not completed.	The product remains draft and not for external distribution.

12.2 Human accountability

ACCOUNTABILITY

An accountable human professional must validate the evidence, final confidence, legal feasibility, technical accuracy, recommendation proportionality, product status, audience, handling, and release version. The user's first-pass review improves the draft but does not transfer institutional approval to the GPT or establish Tornberg Consulting, LLC authorship.

12.3 Lessons learned

Lesson	Implication
Warning architecture	A demonstrated exploit can justify warning without proving scale. This distinction protects decision-makers from both complacency and inflated claims.
Metric architecture	Vector-specific observable measures are more useful than a single score built on incomparable inputs.
Data architecture	Registration data is simultaneously an administrative asset, an error surface, a fraud-enabling pathway under some conditions, and a foreign-intelligence or influence target.
Control architecture	Prevention and forensics are complementary. Input assurance without independent outcome evidence is incomplete; forensic reconstruction without preventive controls is late and inefficient.
Fairness architecture	Election integrity includes lawful inclusion and exclusion. False acceptance and false rejection must both be measured.
Source architecture	Advocacy and investigative sources can expose real pathways. Their value depends on visible evidence, provenance, bounded use, and independent verification - not organizational identity alone.
Review architecture	High-consequence preliminary products should display incomplete review rather than hide it behind polished formatting.

12.4 Remaining substantive gaps

- No representative national incident and disposition universe.
- Unknown detection probability and observability for many successful or attempted events.
- Incomplete bridge evidence from vulnerability or attempt to accepted ballot, count, certification, or outcome effect.
- Limited comparative evidence concerning control coverage, performance, bypass, and residual risk.
- Jurisdictional legal and procedural variation limits aggregation.
- Many vectors lack appropriate exposure denominators.
- Actor attribution, intent, authorization, and coordination remain incomplete.
- The evidence base remains stronger for registration and conventional fraud than for campaign finance, insiders, vendors, certification, and some information effects.
- Warning thresholds, ownership, cadence, and response procedures are not nationally standardized.
- The source packet is selected rather than complete and has not completed full source audit.

Appendix A. Executed Project Pathway

Only work that actually occurred is included below.

Pathway element	Executed record
Baseline and decision supported	Extended the prior PRC-specific baseline into a preliminary national assessment for a senior analyst advising the National Authority. The supported decision was prioritization of election-security awareness, mitigation, collection, warning, and review.
Discovery stages and instruments used	Establish Position; Define Destination; Explore Terrain; Select Instruments; Learn and Adapt. DI-200 Decision Discovery, DI-300 Baseline Development, DI-400 Environmental Discovery, DI-600 Risk Discovery, DI-700 Collection Design, and DI-800 Discovery Integration.
Collection and source work performed	Reviewed official federal administrative, legal, technical, intelligence, academic, investigative, advocacy, commercial, and case-database materials; expanded collection in response to vector and gap development; used the uploaded EAVS report, O'Keefe testimony, Heritage export, prior PRC products, and selected public sources.
Independence, provenance, corroboration, and gap controls	Characterized sources by class and permitted use; deconflicted derivative streams; separated official corroboration from shared-origin evidence; quarantined unsupported numerical claims; retained contrary evidence; created G-01 through G-10.
Methods executed and vulnerability addressed	Question decomposition; evidence-stage mapping; source characterization; data-quality assessment; contradiction and falsification checks; iterative assumption review; vulnerability and exposure analysis; indicators and warning; analyst-led alternative analysis; consequence and recommendation traceability.
Deliverable created	A 29-page Preliminary National-Level Assessment containing executive judgments, national baseline, 15-vector register, preventive and forensic controls, recommendations, gaps, indicators, assumptions, alternatives, source register, and review requirements.
Production requirements applied	Decision alignment, audience and scope, executive lead, evidence/assessment separation, confidence, baseline effect, quantitative boundaries, recommendation traceability, preliminary markings, version identity, source register, and explicit review requirements.
Human-accountability provisions	Prominent draft status; no claim of approval; user first-pass review acknowledged; accountable human validation required for evidence, confidence, legal/technical accuracy, recommendations, and release.
Unresolved gaps and limitations	No classified access; no complete national incident census; incomplete source packet; no independent legal opinion, cost model, technical validation, full source audit, peer review, red team, compliance review, approval, or release authorization.

Appendix B. Framework-to-Output Traceability

Function / standard	Process artifact	Visible product result
Client Discovery / Baseline	Prior PRC baseline, user direction, decision need, scope, horizon.	Purpose, scope, operational baseline, and baseline effects.
DI-200 Decision Discovery	National Authority audience and required decision support.	Executive Assessment and Decision Considerations.
DI-300 Baseline Development	Successive baseline updates as vector logic and controls changed.	Reinforces/refines/contradicts/replaces statements.
DI-400 Environmental Discovery	Lifecycle, legal, technical, foreign, domestic, and administrative terrain.	National Exposure and Assurance Baseline.
DI-600 Risk Discovery	Vector, vulnerability, failure, consequence, and control identification.	Threat Vector-Gap Register and Integrated Assessment.
DI-700 Collection Design	Gaps converted into requirements and indicators.	G-01 through G-10; Priority Information Gaps; indicators.
FS100 Collection	Targeted public-source expansion and falsification.	Selected Source Register and bounded quantitative anchors.
FS200 Source Management	Provenance, characterization, independence, corroboration, quarantine.	Evidence status vocabulary, source limitations, and source dispositions.
FS300 Analysis	Baseline, risk, indicators, implications, and confidence.	Priority judgments, vector records, integrated assessment.

Function / standard	Process artifact	Visible product result
FS500 Quality	Iterative user review, consistency checks, draft status, review requirements.	Appendix C of companion product and this process summary.
FS600 Challenge	Collaborative challenge, assumption review, alternatives, devil's-advocacy checks.	Assumptions, Alternatives, and Limitations. Independent Red Team not completed.
PS-2000 Product Architecture	Executive lead; evidence; assessment; implications; decision considerations; recommendations; gaps.	Visible section architecture of the 29-page draft.
PS-3000 Evidence Integration	Source IDs, characterization, provenance, independence, data limits.	Selected Source Register and claim boundaries.
PS-4000 Analytical Expression	Fact/inference/assessment separation; confidence; baseline effect; assumptions; alternatives; quantitative limits.	Controlled definitions, evidence status, confidence, and frequency-language rule.
PS-7000 Review	Review requirements identified but not completed.	Unqualified release not authorized.
PS-8000 Lifecycle	Product ID, date, draft status, handling, update and review conditions.	Preliminary Intelligence Assessment 2026-02 and Process Summary 2026-02A.

Appendix C. Source-Control Summary

Class	Control rule	Examples
Primary official data/guidance	Direct support for bounded administrative, legal, technical, and threat propositions.	EAC, Census, DOJ, NIST, CISA/FBI/ODNI.
Judicial/prosecutorial	Conduct, evidentiary substrate, legal status, and disposition; legal status did not automatically establish scale or effect.	Armstrong matter and election-crime records.
Academic/consensus	Methodological context, false-positive/negative risk, independent evidence, audit, and resilience.	MIT and National Academies.
Investigative observation	Direct observation where audiovisual or contemporaneous artifacts existed; broader scale and legal disposition remained bounded.	O'Keefe testimony and video.
Advocacy/commercial	Lead generation, case discovery, method examples, and within-dataset patterns only after visible source controls.	FVF, Tilores, PILF, Heritage, Bradley, Gitnux, Zipdo.
Prior synthesis	Baseline and method context; not independent corroboration beyond underlying sources.	PRC baseline and time-gated source-control products.

Appendix D. Methods Used and Not Used

Status	Methods
Executed	Decision framing; baseline development; environmental discovery; risk discovery; collection design; evidence mapping; source characterization/deconfliction; data-quality assessment; direct falsification; iterative assumption review; vulnerability/exposure analysis; indicators and warning; alternatives; consequence and recommendation traceability.
Partially executed	Editorial and visual production QA; author-style consistency review; collaborative challenge. These do not equal independent peer, compliance, red-team, technical, legal, or release review.
Not executed	Composite risk scoring; national incidence estimation; Bayesian/Monte Carlo modeling; formal ACH matrix; independent Team A/Team B; independent Red Team; complete source audit; legal opinion; technical certification; cost/staffing model; approval or release authorization.

Appendix E. Outstanding Review and Release Checklist

Review	Minimum requirement	Status
Source audit	Verify every material claim, quotation, statistic, URL, source date, case disposition, source independence, definition, and limitation; align source packet to exact release version.	Outstanding

Review	Minimum requirement	Status
Legal review	Assess federal and state authority, due process, privacy, access, NVRA, HAVA, UOCAVA, Voting Rights Act, and implementation pathway.	Outstanding
Technical review	Validate cybersecurity, voting systems, e-pollbooks, audit methods, logging, vendor, custody, continuity, and manual-fallback statements.	Outstanding
Tradecraft compliance	Test framing, evidence-stage separation, confidence, alternatives, detectability, metric validity, recommendation traceability, and AI assistance.	Completed
Independent peer review	Examine reasonableness, completeness, evidence sufficiency, assumptions, alternatives, and principal judgments.	Completed
Red-team review	Challenge vector selection, principal systemic judgment, exclusion risk, decentralization, centralization, common-mode failure, and unintended consequences.	Outstanding
Editorial and visual proof	Verify consistency, tables, citations, accessibility, contrast, pagination, cross-references, print behavior, and version identity.	Completed
Approval and release	Designated accountable authority approves source packet, assessment, recommendations, audience, handling, and release version.	Outstanding

FINAL PROCESS STATUS

The process summarized here produced a structured, evidence-controlled, and decision-oriented preliminary draft. It has completed collaborative Discovery, source development, analysis, production, and one reported human first-pass review. It has not completed the independent review, audit, approval, or release functions required for an unqualified final product.

Appendix F. Governing and Companion References

ID	Reference
C-01	Preliminary National-Level Assessment: Risks, Vulnerabilities, and Threat Vectors Affecting the U.S. Electoral Process. Preliminary Intelligence Assessment 2026-02. 18 July 2026. 29 pages. Draft.
M-01	Tornberg Organizational Framework and Tradecraft Standards, Version 0.1 Working Draft.
M-02	Tornberg Consulting Decision Support Products: Production Standards, Version 1 Working Draft.
M-03	Tornberg Consulting Structured Analytic Techniques, Version 0.1 Working Draft.
M-04	Tornberg Consulting Organizational Charter, Version 0.1 Working Draft.
M-05	Application of the Tornberg Method to Time-Gated Evidence Deconfliction. Process Summary Report 2026-01.
M-06	Tornberg Public Source Packet 2026-01.

END OF DRAFT PROCESS SUMMARY - REVIEW, COORDINATION, AND REVISION REQUIRED